Having named routes allows you to generate URLs or redirects easily:

```
Route::get('/dashboard', function () {
    return view('dashboard');
})->name('dashboard');
```

You can also route directly to a controller method:

```
Route::get('/about', [AboutController::class, 'index']);
```

> *Laravel's routing system is powerful, supporting route groups, middleware, resource controllers, and more.*

3.3 Middleware in Laravel

Middleware provides a mechanism for filtering HTTP requests entering your application. It acts like a layer that sits between the request and response cycle.

Here are some common uses of middleware in Laravel:

- Authentication (`auth`)
- Logging
- CORS
- Input sanitization

Here's how to assign middleware to a route:

```
Route::get('/dashboard', function () {
    return view('dashboard');
})->middleware('auth');
```

You can create custom middleware using the Artisan command:

```
php artisan make:middleware CheckAge
```

Then edit `app/Http/Middleware/EnsureUserIsAdmin.php` and register it in `app/Http/Kernel.php`.

We will explore middleware in more detail in next chapters.

3.4 Request and Response Handling

Laravel simplifies handling HTTP requests and generating responses.